BREEDWISE

FREE BREEDER FIELD GUIDE

THE PUPPY CONTENT PLAYBOOK

How to create puppy content that sells your dogs at the price they're actually worth, in any market.

01 MINDSET 02 ENVIRONMENT 03 STACK 04 DISTRIBUTION

The exact shoot, stack and posting process behind **600K+ views on a single puppy post** and **300K+ followers** across platforms.

INCLUDES: SHOOT-DAY CHECKLIST
+ CONTENT SCORECARD

BREEDWISE.IO

BEFORE WE START

PUPPIES DON'T SELL THEMSELVES ANYMORE.

Five to ten years ago you could post a puppy photo and the inbox filled up. That era is gone. Buyers are scrolling past hundreds of puppies a day, and the breeders who sell, at strong prices in any market, are the ones whose content *proves* their dogs are worth it.

Most breeders don't have a dog problem. They have a **presentation problem.** They produce quality puppies, then show them in bad light, in a cluttered background, off-stack, shot from above, posted once and forgotten.

The buyer can't hold your puppy. They can't see your kennel, meet your sire, or watch your dam move. **All they have is your content.** Whatever your content shows is what your dogs are worth to them.

This playbook is the exact process we use to shoot, stack, and distribute puppy content. It's the same process behind:

> *"If you're running a breeding business and your content doesn't do your dogs justice, that is a very, very big issue."*
>
> BREEDWISE PUPPY CONTENT MASTERCLASS

600K+
views on one puppy post in under 48 hours

0 → 100K
Facebook followers in under 6 months

300K+
followers across IG, FB, TikTok & Threads

$25K
single puppy sales from the cleanest dogs, shown right

HOW TO USE THIS PLAYBOOK

1. **Read it once, start to finish.** The four parts build on each other. Great distribution can't save a bad shot, and a great shot nobody sees is worth nothing.
2. **Print the Shoot-Day Checklist (page 14)** and take it to your next content day.
3. **Take the Content Scorecard (page 15).** It shows you exactly where your content is costing you money, and what to do next.

THE FRAMEWORK

THE PUPPY VALUE EQUATION

Your buyer decides what a puppy is worth based on four things. They **multiply**, they don't add. If any one of them is zero, the whole thing is zero.

QUALITY DOG × **THE RIGHT ENVIRONMENT** × **THE RIGHT STACK** × **REAL DISTRIBUTION**

= THE PRICE YOUR PUPPIES COMMAND

01 **Mindset: what doesn't convert**

Why "cute puppy, posted" stopped working, and the iteration habit that separates breeders who sell from breeders who wait.

02 **Environment: light, background, crew**

Your background is your brand. How to light, where to shoot, and the 3-person crew that gets the shot.

03 **Stack & position: the money shot**

The left-shoulder angle, eye-level camera work, and why *the standard sells.*

04 **Distribution: get seen by buyers**

What each Instagram format is for, what makes a reel travel, the weekly posting ratio, and multiplying across platforms.

One thing no camera can fix: there is no substitute for a quality puppy. This playbook makes sure a quality puppy *looks* like one. Your genetics, your whelping, and your structure still have to be there.

PART ONE · MINDSET

01

WHAT PUPPY CONTENT DOESN'T CONVERT, AND WHY

Most breeders post to get clients, and end up posting content that pushes buyers *away*. Here are the three patterns we see most.

1

✕ "Puppies sell themselves"

Snap a photo, post it, hope. It worked a decade ago. Today it's invisible, because there's no reason to stop, no reason to care, no reason to trust *you*.

✓ Tell a story instead

People don't buy a puppy because you have one. They buy to fulfill a need of their own: a family companion, a show prospect, a foundation dog. Post content that speaks to **that** need.

2

✕ Cute over convincing

What's cute to you isn't cute to everyone. A sleepy pile in the whelping box doesn't tell a serious buyer anything about the dog they're about to invest thousands in.

✓ Show what buyers are judging

Show how your dogs actually interact. Show structure, movement, temperament and confidence. Cute gets a like. **Evidence gets a deposit.**

3

✕ Quick & easy "busywork" content

Content that's fast to make and *feels* like you did your job, but doesn't move the ball forward. Effort that shows no effort.

✓ Let the effort show

If a buyer can't see the time and care you put into your content, how can they be sure you put it into your dogs? **How you present is proof of how you breed.**

> *This is the difference between the breeder selling for little to nothing, with no inquiries, and the breeder who sells puppies no matter what the market is doing.*

PART ONE · MINDSET

THE 10,000 ITERATIONS RULE

You won't know what perfect content looks like until you've made a lot of imperfect content. The breeders who win don't wait to be good. They **start where they are and refine every single shoot.**

HOW IT WORKS

Every shot is data. Instead of posting whatever you got, look at it like a judge would and ask: *what would make this better?*

Maybe the photo looks "alright," but you weren't low enough to be eye level with the puppy. Maybe the stack was off. **Don't post it. Note it, fix it, reshoot it.**

Do that hundreds of times and you build an instinct for what makes a buyer feel something. That instinct is what years of content gives you, and it's why we take content so seriously.

> **Reframe:** "This photo doesn't do them justice" isn't an excuse. In a breeding business, it's a problem that limits your growth. Buyers rarely get to see your dogs in person, so your content *is* your dogs.

The Keep-or-Reshoot Review

Run every shot through this before it gets posted. One "no" = reshoot.

- [ ] Was the camera at the puppy's eye level?
- [ ] Is the puppy facing the light, with no harsh shadows?
- [ ] Is the stack clean: feet aligned, top line level?
- [ ] Is the puppy looking at the camera, alert and confident?
- [ ] Is the background clean and minimal, with no clutter or mess?
- [ ] Does this make my dog look *worth more?*
- [ ] Does it match my breed standard, not just what's popular online?
- [ ] Would a serious buyer stop scrolling for this?

What I'll fix next shoot:

Not sure what's wrong with your shots? On a free strategy call, we'll review your actual content and tell you what to fix first.

Book a call →

PART TWO · ENVIRONMENT

LIGHT IT RIGHT

02

Outside of the dog itself, your environment is the most important part of your content. Used right, it raises your pricing *and* defines your brand. It starts with light.

THE GOLDEN RULE OF LIGHT

The puppy faces the sun.
The shooter keeps their back to the sun.

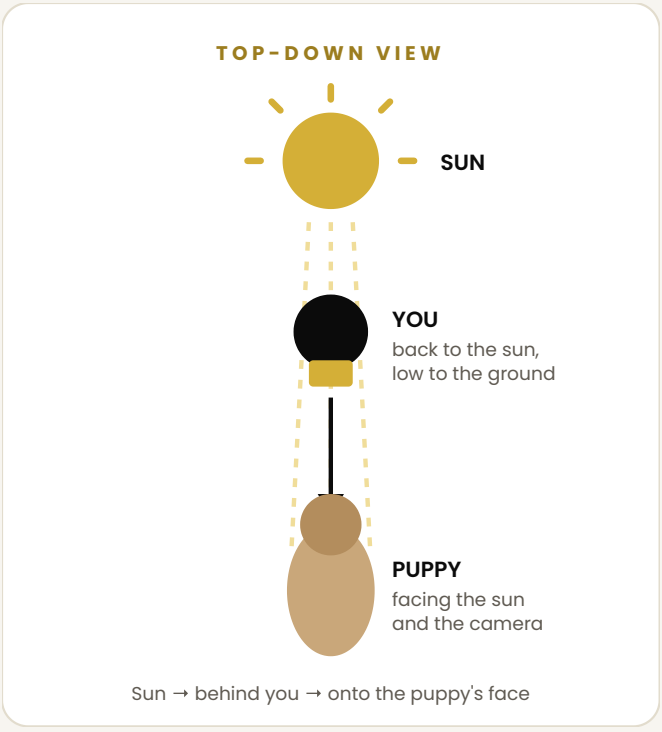
It doesn't matter if *you're* squinting. The puppy needs the light on its face, so its features, eyes and coat show clearly.

AVOID HARSH MIDDAY SUN

Around **1 to 4pm**, the sun is so harsh that your puppy overheats quickly and you can't get flattering light on its features. Shoot earlier in the morning or later in the afternoon, when the light is softer.

INDOORS? USE A KEY LIGHT

Inside, your "sun" is a key light. Same rule: light falls on the puppy's face, bright enough to illuminate but never overbearing or harsh.



Quick test: look at the puppy's eyes on your screen. If you can see a catchlight (a small bright reflection), your light is right. Dark, shadowed eyes mean turn the puppy toward the light.

PART TWO · ENVIRONMENT

YOUR BACKGROUND IS YOUR BRAND

Every piece of content you post is part of your brand, whether you mean it to be or not. Whatever viewers see around your dog, they attach to your dog.

DEFINITION

BRANDING IS THE PAIRING OF TWO THINGS WITH A SPECIFIC OUTCOME AS THE RESULT.

Put a puppy in a clean, minimal, luxury setting, and buyers pair **luxury** with your puppy. The outcome they expect from buying from you: **a luxury dog.** It's that simple, and most breeders never think about it.

THE VALUE TEST: ASK BEFORE EVERY SHOOT

"Does this environment make my dogs look like they're worth more, or does it justify their value?"

If the answer is no, you're in the wrong environment. Move.

VALUE KILLERS

- Whelping box shots with poop or mess in frame
- Clutter, random objects, or stuff on the ground
- A home interior where the aesthetic isn't on point
- Busy backgrounds that compete with the dog
- Spaces other dogs have used (also a health risk for young puppies)

VALUE BUILDERS

- Simple, minimal, clean backgrounds
- Nothing going on except the dog
- Upscale, well-kept settings that "speak" quality
- Sanitary locations safe for young puppies
- The same standard for your **adult dogs**, not just puppies

Action step: scout three locations near you this week that pass the Value Test: a clean driveway, a manicured lawn, a minimal wall. Rotate between them.

THE SHOOT CREW & THE SHOOT PROTOCOL

A puppy can stack for one second. Getting a **5 to 10 second** clip of a confident, stacked puppy looking down the lens takes a team and a process.

Shooter

Photographer or videographer. Low and eye level with the puppy. Back to the light.

Stacker

Sets the stack, angles the puppy toward the shooter's left shoulder, then steps out of frame.

Distractor

Has **one job:** get attention. Stands **directly behind the shooter** so the puppy looks straight into the lens.

THE 2-MINUTE ACCLIMATION

1. Set the puppy down in the new space and give it **about two minutes** to feel it out.
2. Try a stack. If the puppy acts timid, let it explore again.
3. Once confidence builds, pick it up and **affirm it:** "Good job. Good boy. Good girl."
4. Re-stack and shoot. **A nervous puppy makes a shot you can't be confident in.**

DISTRACTOR TOOLKIT

Excited "yes, yes, yes!" · slap the ground · drag your feet · squeaky toy · crinkle sound. Rotate sounds: the same noise stops working after a few tries.

Shooting solo?

Go **organic.** Instead of stacking and running back to the camera, catch the puppy in its natural element. Use a sound or a toy to make it perk up, and capture the moment it stacks itself. It's easier while they're young. As they get older and more sporadic, teach a family member or friend to stack or distract.

VERTICAL VS. HORIZONTAL

SHOOTING FOR	HOLD THE CAMERA
Instagram Reels, TikTok, Stories	**Vertical** (yes, even a real camera)
YouTube, wide Facebook posts	**Horizontal**

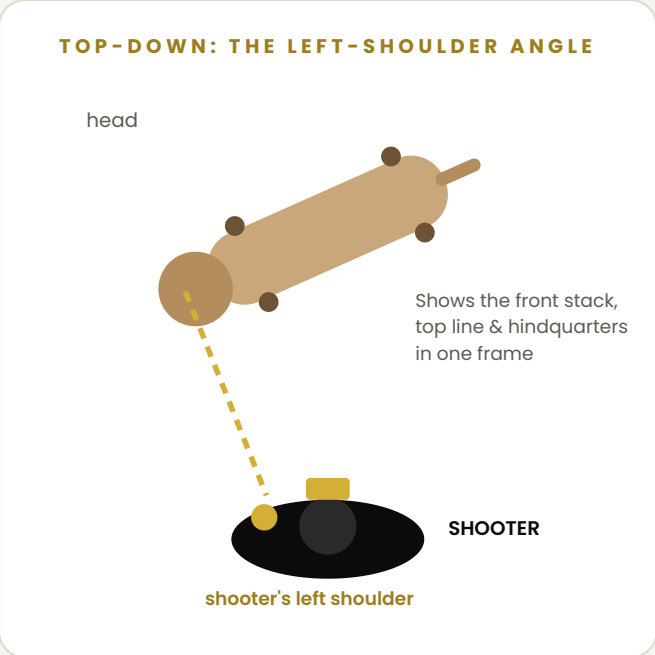
Phone or camera, don't wait for better gear. Get the most out of the tools you have. You only reach the next level by taking the first step.

PART THREE · STACK & POSITION

THE MONEY SHOT

03

When you stack a dog, you're showcasing it as if it's in the show ring. If you don't, you're letting down your dogs, your clients and yourself, because your content dictates your pricing.



1. POINT TO THE LEFT SHOULDER

The stacker angles the dog **slightly** toward the shooter's left shoulder. Most viewers won't notice, but it shows the **front stack, top line and hindquarters** in one frame: rear angulation, tight feet, how everything lines up.

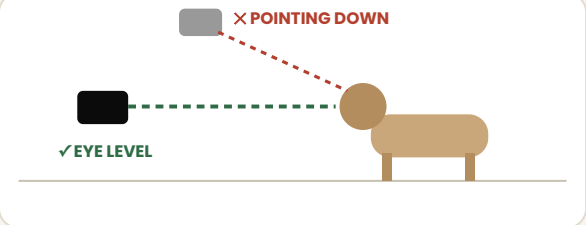
Front stacks and full side stacks can be stunning too. The left-shoulder angle is the one that delivers most consistently.

2. FIX THE FRONT FEET

Not splayed. Not "east-west." The front feet should be aligned with each other and square to the camera, with front width proportionate to your breed standard.

3. HEALTHY, NOT EXTREME

No over-exaggerated fronts or poses that make a dog look potentially unhealthy. You want a healthy display that emphasizes your breed standard.



4. GET DOWN TO EYE LEVEL

The camera points **directly** at the puppy: not down, not up. That means kneeling, lying down, whatever it takes. Eye contact with the lens is what makes the shot.

THE STANDARD SELLS.

The highest puppy sales in our breeding program's history, including **$25,000 puppies**, came from the **cleanest dogs we've ever produced.** They had what the market wanted *and* the standard and structure, and the content showed it.

You can't stack to a standard you don't know. Master your breed standard, then grade your puppies **against the standard, not against what's popular online.**

When you know the details and stack to emphasize them, buyers see a high-quality puppy *according to the standard.* That's when pricing power shows up.

> **Homework:** study how your breed is presented in the show ring. How are they supposed to look stacked? That's your target for every shot.

My Breed Standard Stack Sheet

Fill this in once. Keep it on your phone for every shoot.

TRAIT	WHAT MY STANDARD CALLS FOR
Frame & proportion	
Front width / shoulder	
Head & muzzle ratio	
Length of back / top line	
Rear angulation & hocks	
Tail set & carriage	
Bone & feet	
Coat length & texture	

Example (American Bully): the muzzle is roughly one-third of the head, so the stack and angle should show it.

TRAIN CAMERA-READY PUPPIES

4W — **Start stacking in the whelping box.** Once eyes and ears are open and they can stand on their own.

4-6W — **Repeat daily, like desensitization** or neurological stimulation. Stacking becomes familiar.

6W — **Shoot in a sanitary location.** Trained puppies stack immediately, with each one done in 3 to 5 minutes.

Want a second set of eyes on your puppies' structure? Bring your breed and your latest litter to a free strategy call.

Book a call →

PART FOUR · DISTRIBUTION

GET SEEN BY THE RIGHT BUYERS

04

You can have the best content in the world, but if nobody knows who you are, it means nothing. Distribution is where the content you worked for starts paying you back.

EVERY INSTAGRAM FORMAT HAS ONE JOB

FORMAT	ITS JOB	USE IT FOR
Reels	Bring in **new followers**	Your best stacked clips, short and rewatchable. This is your growth engine.
Photos	**Feed** current followers	Hero shots of puppies and adults that reinforce your quality.
Carousels	**Educate** new and current followers	Breed standard breakdowns, how you raise puppies, what to look for in a breeder.
Stories	Build **trust**	Behind the scenes: daily care, whelping, training, your real life as a breeder.

WHAT MAKES A REEL TRAVEL IN 2026

Likes and comments were the big signals around 2020. Today the platforms want to keep people watching, so **watch time and rewatches** matter most.

Show the algorithm that people watch your content, and it puts every future post in front of new people. Your reel doesn't depend on *your* followers being online. A good reel performs at any time of day.

The 5 levers: **music · length/speed · angle · caption** · and time of day, which matters far less than people think.

Views ≠ sales

Plenty of breeders get millions of views and still can't sell a litter. Going viral doesn't mean people read your content the way you intended. Every post has to move a buyer down this path:

WATCH → FEEL → FOLLOW → REACH OUT

The emotion has to be strong enough to make them DM you. That's buyer psychology 101.

THE WEEKLY RATIO & THE POSTING PLAY

One great post that goes viral, followed by weeks of silence, won't earn a stranger's trust with thousands of dollars. **Consistency builds demand before you have supply.**

WEEKLY	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Reel · 1+/day	●	●	●	●	●	●	●
Stories · 3–5/day	3–5	3–5	3–5	3–5	3–5	3–5	3–5
Carousel · 2/week		●			●		
Photo · 1–2/week			●			●	
Batch day · 4 hrs	Pick one day a week and create content for four hours. Build a **content bank** you can pull from all week, so you don't have to shoot every day.						

THE 6-STEP REEL POSTING PLAY

01 Select
Pick the clip from your content bank that best passes the Keep-or-Reshoot Review.

02 Trim
Cut it to **3 to 6 seconds**, the length people will watch and rewatch. Nothing crazy.

03 Sound
Choose audio that pairs with the clip and ideally is trending. Trending audio matters less than it used to, but it still helps.

04 Caption
One sentence, not a paragraph. Write the emotion you want them to feel: *"This is the cutest puppy I've ever seen."*

05 Cover
Set a cover image someone scrolling would want to tap. It has to stand out in a grid.

06 Post
Posting is the easy part. The real work is everything you did before this step.

> **Rule:** keep every post at the same level of quality. Your feed is a promise, so don't break it with filler on busy weeks. That's what the batch day is for.

PART FOUR · DISTRIBUTION

MASTER ONE PLATFORM. THEN MULTIPLY.

Get great on Instagram first. Then take what works and rebuild it natively on every other platform. Each one is a new channel of leads.

1. **Create a Facebook business page** for your breeding program. Don't post business content to your personal page.
2. **Connect it to Instagram** so every post automatically publishes to your Facebook business page too.
3. **Rebuild, don't repost, for TikTok and YouTube.** Don't just save your Instagram video and dump it. Run the same 6-step play on each platform: native caption, **that platform's** trending sound, its own cover.
4. **Do the details.** That's where all the magic happens.

Platform priority for breeders

Primary: Instagram + Facebook (connected)
Secondary: YouTube + TikTok

WHAT THIS DID FOR US

0 → 100K

FACEBOOK FOLLOWERS IN UNDER 6 MONTHS, AFTER WE FINALLY STARTED ON FB IN 2025

300K+

FOLLOWERS ACROSS INSTAGRAM, FACEBOOK, TIKTOK & THREADS

600K+

VIEWS ON A SINGLE PUPPY POST IN UNDER 48 HOURS

We've also helped breeders go from zero to 100K+ followers using this same process.

Notice what came first. Distribution only multiplied what was already working: a quality dog, in the right environment, stacked right, shot at eye level. Skip parts 1 to 3 and you just multiply content that doesn't convert.

PRINT ME · TOOL 01

SHOOT-DAY CHECKLIST

Take this to every content day. Puppy: _____ Date: _____
Location: _____

BEFORE YOU GO

- ☐ Puppies stack-trained (started ~4 weeks)
- ☐ Location passes the Value Test: clean, minimal, upscale
- ☐ Location is sanitary, with no other dogs' traffic
- ☐ Shoot window avoids 1–4pm harsh sun
- ☐ Crew assigned: Shooter · Stacker · Distractor
- ☐ Breed Standard Stack Sheet on my phone
- ☐ Batteries charged, storage cleared, lens wiped
- ☐ Water, shade, treats, toys, noise-makers

ON SET

- ☐ 2-minute acclimation for each puppy
- ☐ Puppy faces the light, shooter's back to the light
- ☐ Camera at eye level, not pointing up or down
- ☐ Angle slightly to the shooter's left shoulder
- ☐ Front feet aligned, not splayed or east-west
- ☐ Distractor directly behind the shooter

SHOT LIST PER PUPPY

- ☐ Left-shoulder stack: 5–10 second clip (vertical)
- ☐ Left-shoulder stack: still photo
- ☐ Front stack
- ☐ Full side stack
- ☐ Head close-up, eye contact with the lens
- ☐ Movement / interaction clip
- ☐ Horizontal version for YouTube / Facebook
- ☐ Behind-the-scenes clips for Stories

AFTER THE SHOOT

- ☐ Run every shot through Keep-or-Reshoot
- ☐ File keepers into my content bank
- ☐ Schedule 7 reels, 2 carousels, 1–2 photos
- ☐ Write down one thing to improve next time

TOOL 02 · 3 MINUTES

THE PUPPY CONTENT SCORECARD

Be honest. Circle one score for each statement: **0 = rarely · 1 = sometimes · 2 = always.**

#	STATEMENT	SCORE
1	My posts tell a story that speaks to what my buyer wants, not just "puppies available."	0 1 2
2	I review every shot and reshoot anything off-stack, off-angle, or above eye level.	0 1 2
3	I shoot with the puppy facing the light, and I avoid harsh midday sun.	0 1 2
4	My backgrounds are clean and minimal, and they make my dogs look worth more.	0 1 2
5	I have a stacker and distractor (or a solid solo system) on every shoot.	0 1 2
6	My puppies are stack-trained from about 4 weeks, so they're camera-ready.	0 1 2
7	I know my breed standard in detail and stack to it, not to what's trending.	0 1 2
8	I post at least one reel a day and 3–5 stories a day.	0 1 2
9	I batch-create content in a dedicated weekly session and post from a content bank.	0 1 2
10	My content consistently brings DMs from **qualified buyers**, not just views and likes.	0 1 2
	MY TOTAL SCORE (OUT OF 20)	

Got your number? Turn the page to see what it means, and what to do next.

YOUR RESULTS

WHAT YOUR SCORE IS TELLING YOU

0-8
LEAVING MONEY ON THE TABLE

Your content is underpricing your dogs. Buyers are judging your puppies by content that doesn't show what they're worth. The fastest win is your fundamentals: light, environment, stack. Small fixes here move your pricing more than anything else.

9-15
GOOD DOGS, LEAKING VALUE

You've got pieces of the system, but not the system. Some posts land; most don't. Inconsistency is quietly costing you inquiries. You need a repeatable process: crew, content bank, and a posting cadence you can actually keep.

16-20
READY TO SCALE

Your content works. Your bottleneck is now the business behind it: converting DMs into deposits, pricing, a waitlist, and building demand ahead of your next litters.

HERE'S THE HONEST TRUTH

A PDF CAN SHOW YOU THE PLAYBOOK. IT CAN'T LOOK AT YOUR DOGS.

It can't tell you which of your shots are underselling your puppies, whether your stack matches *your* breed's standard, or why your reels get views but no DMs.

That's what a strategy call is for. In one conversation, we look at your actual content and program and tell you exactly what to fix first, so your next litter sells at the price it deserves.

BREEDWISE

YOUR NEXT STEP

BOOK YOUR FREE PUPPY CONTENT STRATEGY CALL

The best time to fix your content is **before your next litter hits the ground**. Bring your dogs and your account. We'll bring the playbook and apply it to your program, live.

ON THE CALL, WE'LL:

1. **Audit your content live:** your profile, your recent posts, your best and worst shots.
2. **Find your pricing gap:** where your content is making your dogs look like they're worth less than they are.
3. **Map your next 90 days:** environment, crew, cadence and distribution for your next litter.
4. **Show you how we can help**, if it's a fit. In Breedwise Academy you get the full system, with camera and iPhone training. In the Accelerator, our team works hand-in-hand with you and creates content for you.

This call is for you if...

- You breed quality dogs and want pricing to match
- You're serious about running breeding as a business
- You're willing to put in the work. We'll show you where.

Come prepared with:

- Your Instagram / Facebook handle
- Your Content Scorecard total
- When your next litter is due

CLAIM YOUR STRATEGY CALL

Answer a few quick questions, then pick a time that works for you.

BOOK MY CALL →

SCAN TO BOOK

We want to see every breeder who's doing it the right way win. Let's make sure your content does your dogs justice.